

Starting a computer and loading an operating system is known as 'booting'. Usually, most of the operating systems load in the background, as you switch on your computer. However, FreeBSD has some unique features to add flexibility to the booting process.

In this chapter, we will understand the correct process to boot and configure your system. Again, you must be aware that shutting down is not just by switching your personal computer off. The process puts all your ongoing apps on a halt in a systematic manner. We will also discuss the ideal operation sequence to shut down your FreeBSD system.

Let's boot

Unlike most other commonly used operating systems, FreeBSD offers way more flexibility to choose your desired option during the booting process. You can customise the way your FreeBSD system starts. It allows you to:

- Select from the multiple operating systems installed on the same computer.
- Choose the desired version of the same operating system.
- Select a different installed kernel.

Choosing a different kernel helps improve the interaction between your input and output devices.

It is vital to learn about the components of FreeBSD bootstrap system, the interaction between them, the options to pass to the components to control your booting process, customising bootstrap splash screen, booting into single or multi-user modes.

Let us figure out the booting and configuration process in a step-by-step manner:

The boot manager plays a vital role in the process of booting your FreeBSD system. The Basic Input/Output System (BIOS) searches on the disk for Master Boot Record (MBR) and



Flexibility to configure your OS

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